



# ENG508

**Mid-Term**

## ABSTRACT

*This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.*

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### Q. Modality

Modality is a linguistic category that modifies the meaning of an event or action by expressing the speaker's attitude.

- Epistemic Modality: Indicates the degree of certainty or belief (e.g., "He must be at home").
- Deontic Modality: Relates to permission, obligation, and necessity (e.g., "You must finish your homework").

### Q. Hyponyms

Hyponymy is a semantic relationship where the meaning of one word (the hyponym) is included in another (the superordinate).

Example: "Dog" is a hyponym of "animal"; "rose" is a hyponym of "flower".

### Q. Leech's Five Functions of Language

Leech proposed five functions of language:

- Informational: Conveying content or factual information.
- Expressive: Expressing the speaker's emotions or attitudes.
- Directive: Influencing the behavior of others (commands, requests).
- Aesthetic: Language used for its own sake (e.g., poetry).
- Phatic: Maintaining social relationships (e.g., greetings).

### Q. Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

- Transitive Verbs: Require an object. E.g., "She ate an apple."
- Intransitive Verbs: Do not require an object. E.g., "He laughed."

Causativity is related, where an agent causes an action (e.g., "He made her cry").

### Q. Characteristics of Color Terms

Berlin and Kay (1969) outlined four criteria for basic color terms:

1. Monolexemic – Not compound (e.g., "blue", not "blue-grey").
2. Not a hyponym – Not a subtype of another color (e.g., "red" vs. "scarlet").
3. Wide applicability – Used across many contexts.
4. Not derived from an object – E.g., "turquoise" (from a stone) is not basic.

English has eleven basic color terms (e.g., red, blue, green).

*Compilation*

### **Q. Utterance Semantics & Semantics in Model of Grammar**

- Utterance Semantics: Focuses on how meaning is constructed in actual speech, including context and speaker intention.
- Semantics in a Model of Grammar: Semantics is one component of grammar, alongside syntax and phonology. It's responsible for assigning meaning to syntactic structures.

### **Q. Distinction between Grammar and Lexicon**

- Grammar: Concerns rules for combining words (syntax, morphology).
- Lexicon: Deals with word meanings.

Chomsky's sentence "Colorless green ideas sleep furiously" is grammatically correct but lexically nonsensical—illustrating their separation.

### **Q. Idea Theory of Meaning**

The Idea Theory (or Mentalist Theory) posits that meaning is a mental image or idea in the mind of the speaker or hearer. This view has been criticized for being too subjective and failing to explain how communication is successful when mental images vary.

### **Q. Hyponymy and Polysemy**

- Hyponymy: As noted, a "type-of" relationship (e.g., "rose" is a type of "flower").
- Polysemy: A single word with multiple related meanings. E.g., "hook" can mean a curved object, a fish-hook, or a trap—all related in meaning.

### **Q. Berlin and Kay: Universal Inventory of Colors**

Berlin and Kay (1969) proposed that:

- Basic color terms are monolexemic, not hyponyms, have wide applicability, and are not derived from objects.
- English has 11 basic color terms: white, black, red, green, yellow, blue, brown, purple, pink, orange, and grey.

### **Q. Presupposition**

Presupposition is what a speaker assumes to be true before making an utterance.

**Example:** "The king of France is bald" presupposes that there is a king of France.

Types include: existential, factive, non-factive, lexical, structural, and counterfactual.

Presupposition failure leads to truth-value gaps.

### **Q. Transitive and Intransitive Verbs**

- Transitive: Requires an object (e.g., He ate food).

- Intransitive: Does not take an object (e.g., She laughed).

**Q. Truth-Based Problem**

- Based on truth-conditional semantics: to know a sentence's meaning is to know its truth conditions.
- If the presupposition is false (e.g., The King of France is bald), it leads to a truth-value gap, meaning the sentence is neither true nor false.

**Q. Three Thematic Roles**

- Agent: initiator (e.g., Rashid cooked the meat).
- Theme: the entity moved or located (e.g., The book is in the library).
- Experiencer: feels or perceives but does not act (e.g., Kamran heard the door).

**Q. Conceptual Meaning**

Concerned with literal, dictionary meaning. It is context-independent and helps in logical inference and truth-conditions.

**Q. Define Proposition and Three Levels of Language**

Proposition: The underlying meaning of a sentence, which can be true or false.

Three Levels:

1. Phonological – sound
2. Syntactic – structure
3. Semantic – meaning.

**Q. Euphemism and Image Building**

- Euphemism: A polite or indirect word used instead of a harsh or offensive one (e.g., passed away for died).
- Image Building: Using language (like euphemisms) to shape social perception or self-image.

**Q. Edward Sapir's View: Psychological Reality**

Sapir believed that language reflects the mental world of speakers. It's not just a communication tool but tied deeply to thought and perception.

**Q. Grammatical Category: Gender**

- English lacks grammatical gender but uses pronouns (he, she, it) to mark sex.
- In other languages, grammatical gender can affect adjective agreement, article use, etc..

**Q. Literal vs Non-Literal Meaning**

- Literal: Direct, dictionary meaning.
- Non-literal: Figurative or implied meaning (e.g., metaphors, idioms).

### **Q. Causative Verbs**

These indicate a change of state caused by an agent (e.g., widen in The council widened the road).

### **Q. Underlined Agents / Agent Definition**

Agent: The doer of an action with intention (volitional).

Often animate, e.g., Ali in Ali opened the door.

### **Q. Define Pragmatics**

Pragmatics studies meaning in context, including speaker intent, assumptions, and implications beyond literal meanings.

### **Q. Lexical Semantics with One Example**

Lexical semantics deals with word meanings and their relationships.

**Example:** Run in “She runs fast” vs. “She runs a business” shows polysemy.

B.Ed. (1.5 Years)

BS English

Files

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